



Rating
Buy

Europe
France

Aerospace & Defence
Aerospace & Defence

Company
Airbus

Reuters
AIR.PA

Bloomberg
AIR FP

Exchange
PAR

Ticker
AIR

ADR
EADSY

ISIN
US29875W1009

Date
22 July 2026

Company Update

Price at 21 Jul 2026 (EUR)	194.60
Price Target	232.00
52-week range	220.20 - 159.18

A mid-term guidance, a €5bn buyback and a flight plan beyond 2029

Airbus disclosed a mid-term guidance that aligned well with current market expectations. The positive surprise, however, came from the €5bn three-year share buy-back. The other key message is that commercial growth will not flatten out in 2029, with widebody and service growth on the agenda. As for Defence & Space and Helicopters, they are set to continue on their growth trajectory. Buy, PT raised from €226 to €232.

Buyback seen as positive signal, while mid-term guidance in line

At its business update, Airbus confirmed its 2026 guidance and disclosed a 2029 mid-term guidance, with an adjusted EBIT of €12-13bn in 2029 versus the Bloomberg consensus of €13bn. This disclosure is underpinned by strong demand and unprecedented visibility across all businesses. The company reaffirmed its cash-conversion target of around 1 over a five-year horizon. More importantly, it announced a much-anticipated €5bn share buyback program over three years, in addition to the 30%-50% dividend payout policy disclosed in 2025. This policy to return approximately 60% of FCF to shareholders should be seen as a positive, in our view.

Growth story to continue post 2029, driven by widebody and services

Widebody ramp-up is expected to continue beyond 2029, with a decision anticipated in 2026 to further increase the A350 production rate. The current target is 12 per month by 2028, but could reach 14-16 in our view. Bottlenecks are mainly on the cabin side for now. A better mix is also on the agenda: Airbus confirmed it is examining both A220 and A350 stretches, provided more powerful engines are available. Pratt should continue to power the A220. Services are also a growth driver, with Airbus aiming to double service sales between 2025 and 2030 to €10bn through organic growth and M&A. Regarding profitability, the A350 is expected to reach its sweet spot beyond 2029, in the 2030s, with services also anticipated to display double-digit margins in 2030. A focus on reducing non-quality incidents by 50% in 2027 should also contribute to profit. Deliveries are expected to be more evenly split across the year post 2028-2029. Longer term, with the advent of the A320 replacement, Airbus also expects to further rebalance its business model and capture more aftermarket revenues.

Defence & Space and Helicopters continue on their growth trajectory

Both divisions continue on the trajectory laid out in June 2025, with the 2029

Valuation & Risks

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Key changes

TP	226.00 to 232.00	↑	2.7%
Source: Deutsche Bank			

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guidance extending the 2028 targets. In Defence & Space, Space is ahead of its set trajectory, with significant traction from constellations and military space. In Defence, growth continues to be fueled by capacity increases, with MRTT production to double and Eurofighter targeting a rate of 28/30 per year. There are still some uncertainties on what Airbus will replace FCAS with. Helicopters continue to grow, driven by military CAGR close to 6%, civil at 4%, and innovations across the entire product portfolio (of 13 products).

Q2 release on 29 July post market

We enclosed our Q2 estimates. The key driver for Airbus Commercial remains 67 extra deliveries year-on-year in Q2. This drives operational leverage, partially offset by FX hedging (€150m headwind in Q2 due to a 4-cent hedge rate appreciation), higher R&D, and Spirit integration costs, aligned with delivery phasing. Airbus Helicopters expects similar volumes year-on-year, while Defence & Space should continue progressing toward its mid-to-high single-digit EBIT margin target. FCF is expected to be positive, supported by higher deliveries despite inventory buildup ahead of H2 back-end loaded deliveries.

Buy, PT raised to €232 (from €226)

We raised our PT from €226 to €232 mainly as the result of the buyback programme on share count. We assumed the following phasing in the buy back : €800m in 2026, €1.6bn in both 2027 and 2028 and €1bn in 2029. Our price target remains based on the average of three methods: a 2028E EV/EBIT SOTP valuation yielding €290 (from €286), where Airbus Commercial is valued at 20x EV/EBIT 2028 (compared with Boeing above 22x) and Defense, Space, and Helicopters at a 15.3x 3-year forward multiple (peer based); a DCF valuation resulting in €197 per share (from €190); and a 4% FCF yield approach based on 2028E, which yields €208 per share (from €202).



Figure 1: Details of the 2029 mid-term guidance vs. current consensus expectations

	Mid-term guidance (2029) - Farnborough 2026	Current Consensus	Mid-term guidance (2028) - Paris Air Show 2025
Group EBIT	€12-13bn EBIT in 2029	13.0	no guidance because environment considered uncertain in 2025
Commercial EBIT	€10bn by 2029	10.6	
Commercial Service revenues	€10bn by 2030		
Helicopter EBIT margin	€1.2bn in 2029	1.16	11%+ (2028)
Defence& Space EBIT or EBIT margin	€1.3bn in 2029	1.36	mid to high single digit margin (1bn+) by 2028
Dividend pay-out	30%-50%	46%	30-50%
Share buy back	€5bn over 3 years		
R&D (€,m)	mid single digit as a % of sales		to continue increasing beyond 2025 , in line with revenues
Capex (€,m)	moderate increase		stabilising in absolute value when getting closer to the targeted production rates

Source : Deutsche Bank, Company, Bloomberg LLP for consensus



Figure 2: Updated estimates post July 2026 business update

	2026E (New)	2026E (Old)	% change	2027E (New)	2027E (Old)	% change	2028E (New)	2028E (Old)	% change	2029E (New)	2029E (Old)	% change
Deliveries	870	870	0%	965	965	0%	1,098	1098	0%	1,198	1198	0%
A220	106	106	0%	125	125	0%	150	150	0%	162	162	0%
A320 Family	654	654		714	714		796	796		861	861	
A319ceo	0	0		0	0		0	0		0	0	
A320ceo	0	0		0	0		0	0		0	0	
A321ceo	0	0		0	0		0	0		0	0	
A319neo	10	10		10	10		6	6		6	6	
A320neo	226	226	0%	242	242	0%	275	275	0%	300	300	0%
A321neo	418	418	0%	462	462	0%	515	515	0%	555	555	0%
A330 Family	38	38		42	42		46	46		50	50	
A330ceo	2	2		2	2		2	2		0	0	
A330neo	36	36	0%	40	40	0%	44	44	0%	50	50	0%
A350	72	72	0%	84	84	0%	106	106	0%	125	125	0%
A350-900	57	57		68	68		89	89		110	110	
A350-1000	15	15		16	16		17	17		15	15	
	2026E (New)	2026E (Old)	% change	2027E (New)	2027E (Old)	% change	2028E (New)	2028E (Old)	% change	2029E (New)	2029E (Old)	% change
Group revenues	80,438	80,438	0.0%	88,571	88,571	0.0%	101,409	101,409	0.0%	113,478	113,478	0.0%
Airbus	58,259	58,259	0%	64,966	64,966	0%	76,178	76,178	0%	86,500	86,500	0%
Helicopters	9,702	9,702	0%	10,493	10,493	0%	11,454	11,454	0%	12,504	12,504	0%
Defence & Space	14,011	14,011	0%	14,646	14,646	0%	15,311	15,311	0%	16,008	16,008	0%
HQ/ Eliminations	-1,534	-1,534	0%	-1,534	-1,534	0%	-1,534	-1,534	0%	-1,534	-1,534	0%
Group EBIT Adjusted	7,746	7,746	0%	8,965	8,922	0%	11,295	11,234	1%	12,990	12,969	0%
% margin	9.6%	9.6%		10.1%	10.1%		11.1%	11.1%		11.4%	11.4%	
Airbus	5,941	5,941	0%	6,916	6,873	1%	8,939	8,829	1%	10,376	10,335	0%
% margin	10.2%	10.2%		10.6%	10.6%		11.7%	11.6%		12.0%	11.9%	
Helicopters	1,014	1,014	0%	1,106	1,106	0%	1,257	1,257	0%	1,372	1,372	0%
% margin	10.5%	10.5%		10.5%	10.5%		11.0%	11.0%		11.0%	11.0%	
Defence & Space	860	860	0%	1,013	1,013	0%	1,169	1,217	-4%	1,313	1,333	-2%
% margin	6.1%	6.1%		6.9%	6.9%		7.6%	8.0%		8.2%	8.3%	
HQ/ Eliminations	-70	-70		-70	-70		-70	-70		-70	-70	
Net income adjusted	5,919	5,937	0%	6,724	6,727	0%	8,528	8,517	0%	9,826	9,833	0%
EPS adjusted	7.51	7.52	0%	8.58	8.52	1%	10.92	10.79	1%	12.61	12.45	1%
Dividend per share	3.50	3.50		4.10	4.10		5.50	5.40		6.30	6.20	
Capex	4,200	4,200		4,500	4,500		4,600	4,600		4,600	4,600	
FCF before customer financing	4,407	4,427	0%	6,059	6,063	0%	7,882	7,870	0%	8,928	8,936	0%
Cash conversion	74%	75%	0%	90%	90%	0%	92%	92%	0%	91%	91%	0%
Closing net cash/ (net debt)	13,337	14,158	-6%	15,126	17,543	-14%	18,279	22,262	-18%	21,999	27,021	-19%

Source : Deutsche Bank



Figure 3: Q2-26 preview

	Q2-26	Q2-25	% change
	est.	act.	
Group revenues	20,074	16,068	25%
Airbus	14,817	11,308	31%
Helicopters	2,267	2,093	8%
Defence & Space	3,373	3,157	7%
HQ/ Eliminations	-384	-369	4%
Group EBIT Adjusted	2,178	1,580	38%
% margin	10.8%	9.8%	
Airbus	1,826	1,220	50%
% margin	12.3%	10.8%	
Helicopters	181	171	6%
% margin	8.0%	8.2%	
Defence & Space	187	188	0%
% margin	5.6%	6.0%	
HQ/ Eliminations	-18	1	
Group EBIT Reported	2,140	1,144	87%
% margin	10.7%	7.1%	
Airbus	1,789	780	
% margin	12.1%	6.9%	
Helicopters	181	171	
% margin	8.0%	8.2%	
Defence & Space	187	192	
% margin	5.6%	6.1%	
HQ/ Eliminations	-18	1	
EPS adjusted	2.04	1.49	37%
FCF before customer financing	278	-1,300	-121%

Source : Deutsche Bank



Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

Disclosure checklist			
Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
Airbus	AIR.PA	194.6 (EUR) 21 Jul 2026	1, 2, 7, 8, 14, 15, 21, 24, 26

*Prices are current as of the end of the previous trading session unless otherwise indicated and are sourced from local exchanges via Reuters, Bloomberg and other vendors. Other information is sourced from Deutsche Bank, subject companies, and other sources. For disclosures pertaining to recommendations or estimates made on securities other than the primary subject of this research, please see the most recently published company report or visit our global disclosure look-up page on our website at <https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/EquityResearchDisclosures>. Aside from within this report, important risk and conflict disclosures can also be found at <https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/Disclaimer>. Investors are strongly encouraged to review this information before investing.

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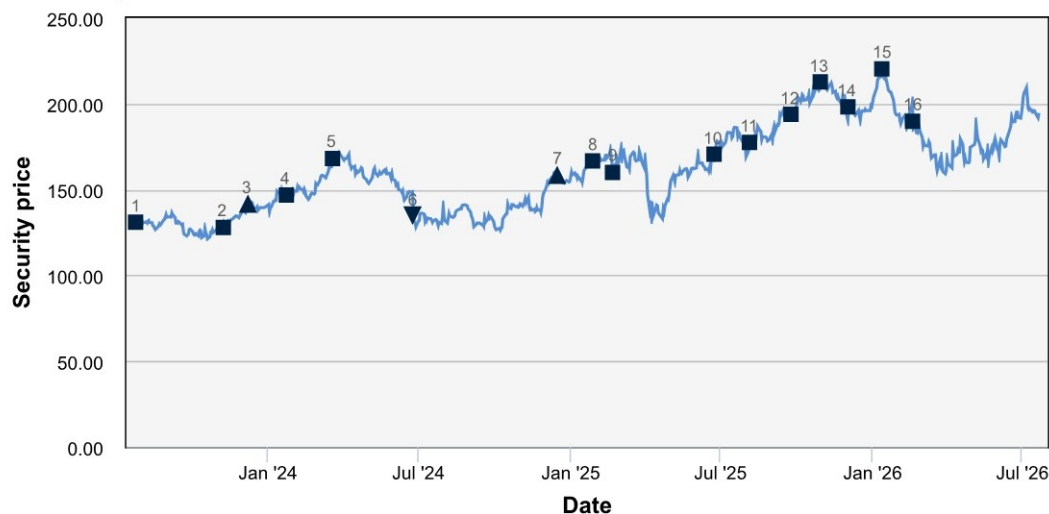
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Historical recommendations and target price: Airbus (AIR.PA)

(as of 07/21/2026)



Current Recommendations

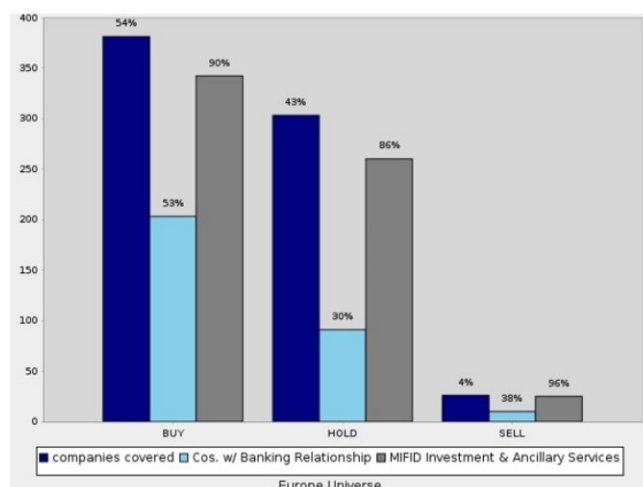
Buy
Hold
Sell
Not Rated
Suspended Rating

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1.	07/27/2023	Hold, Target Price Change EUR 128.00, Current Price EUR 131.00 Christophe Menard	9.	02/22/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 183.00, Current Price EUR 160.00 Christophe Menard
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3.	12/08/2023	Upgraded to Buy, Target Price Change EUR 152.00, Current Price EUR 141.82 Christophe Menard	11.	08/07/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 186.00, Current Price EUR 177.40 Christophe Menard
4.	01/24/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 165.00, Current Price EUR 146.74 Christophe Menard	12.	09/25/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 209.00, Current Price EUR 193.86 Christophe Menard
5.	03/20/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 186.00, Current Price EUR 168.06 Christophe Menard	13.	10/30/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 228.00, Current Price EUR 212.70 Christophe Menard
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8.	01/29/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 187.00, Current Price EUR 166.62 Christophe Menard	16.	02/20/2026	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 226.00, Current Price EUR 189.74 Christophe Menard



Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



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